

# YALE SOM

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## INSIDER TIPS



# ABOUT YALE SOM

Over the past 10 years, Yale SOM has become one of the most sought-after MBA programs with applications topping 4,000 for a class of approximately 350. Yale SOM was the first US program that required international travel for its graduates, and international students comprised 31% of the class of 2020. SOM also benefits from strong connections with Yale University, with an international network and brand recognition rivaled by only a handful of institutions on earth. Few MBA students turn down the opportunity to engage with other departments and take advantage of the rich learning environment around campus.

Under the leadership of Ted Snyder, former dean at Chicago Booth, and now Kerwin Charles, an economist and public policy expert, SOM has continued its rise in the world of business education. The school's gleaming facilities, designed by Norman Foster, reflect the belief that managers need an extended line of sight, and they allude to the values of connection and community. The architecture is a thoughtful proxy for an MBA curriculum that emphasizes cross-functional managerial roles through its core Organizational Perspectives courses that are intended to build community and peer-to-peer learning.

Yale SOM is a great school for people who are intrigued by complex, dynamic problems that will require big ideas and multi-disciplinary solutions. It might be fair to think of it as a "liberal arts" approach to business education. It's a place for curious, forward-thinking students who like to make new connections and see old problems from new angles. The school has distinguished itself as a leader when it comes to

DEI and has invested heavily in programs and partnerships that elevate traditionally underrepresented voices in business and business education.

Finally, Yale SOM very much considers management – not “business” – a profession on par with law, medicine, or architecture. That is, practitioners should not be blind to the moral dimensions of their work and its impact on the public good. Thus, the school is a natural fit for leaders with a strong interest in ESG, and applicants who are drawn to the power and promise of public-private ventures of the kind required to address the world’s most pressing problems (e.g., climate change, global pandemics, extremism, global capitalism, and so on).

## **STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS**

Nonprofit, Corporate Social Responsibility, Strategy, Finance, Public  
Sector Leadership

# KEY STATS

| <b>MBA RANKINGS*</b> | 2012 | 2013 | 2014 | 2015 | 2016 | <b>2017</b> | <b>2018</b> | <b>2019</b> |
|----------------------|------|------|------|------|------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| BusinessWeek         | 21   | -    | 6    | 11   | -    | <b>16</b>   | <b>11</b>   | <b>14</b>   |
| Financial Times      | 12   | 9    | 7    | 9    | -    | <b>9</b>    | <b>9</b>    | <b>8</b>    |
| Forbes               | -    | 18   | -    | 11   | -    | <b>13</b>   | -           | <b>11</b>   |
| The Economist        | 17   | 17   | 14   | 13   | -    | <b>11</b>   | <b>12</b>   | <b>18</b>   |
| US News              | 10   | 13   | 13   | 13   | -    | <b>9</b>    | <b>11</b>   | <b>9</b>    |

## CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

|                        |             |                 |      |
|------------------------|-------------|-----------------|------|
| Number of Applicants   | 3453        | Avg Age         | 28   |
| MBA Class Size         | 350         | Avg GMAT        | 720  |
| Admissions selectivity | 29.70%      | Avg GPA         | 3.65 |
| Yield                  | 34.13%      | % International | 40%  |
| Total Tuition          | US\$149,120 | % Women         | 39%  |

## POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

|                    |       |
|--------------------|-------|
| Consulting         | 36.9% |
| Financial Services | 23.3% |
| Technology         | 12.7% |
| Retail             | 8.9%  |

## TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Kearney, Bain, Deloitte, McKinsey, BCG, L.E.K., PwC, Coca-Cola, Mattel, Pepsi, Nike, Unilever, P&G, Amex, Barclays, Morgan Stanley, Blackrock, JP Morgan, Citi, Credit Suisse, Visa, Merck, Pfizer, Adobe, Apple, Google, TickTock, amazon.com, Costco, Wayfair, Kahoot!, Robin Hood Foundation

**AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$140,000**

**EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 90.2%**

\*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



# TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR YALE SOM APPLICATION

**BY JENIFER RAYER**

Jenifer has worked as Director for the Dean of Faculty, Yale-NUS College, at National University of Singapore, MBA Director at Singapore Management University (SMU), and career services coach at INSEAD and SMU. While earning a dual MBA-MA degree at the Wharton School and the Lauder Institute, she served on the Lauder Institute Admissions Committee for two years.



**To change the world requires thinking and doing at scale, and Yale wants to give its graduates the tools to do so with the aid of a strong moral compass.**

# 1

## DEMONSTRATE INTELLECTUAL CURIOSITY AND A GROWTH MINDSET

Yale SOM looks for people who are intellectually curious and are able to balance a strong career focus with a worldly perspective. The school has developed an interdisciplinary program that remixes the traditional business school modules. It aims to train flexible thinkers who can see the connections between operations and competitive strategy or accounting and workforce management. The school's raw case studies require students to ask the right questions before they get to work on solutions – rewarding both creativity and analytical skills. Yale SOM seeks students who are genuinely interested in expanding their worldview, who see business school as an opportunity for personal, professional, and intellectual transformation.

## HIGHLIGHT YOUR SOCIAL AWARENESS

# 2

Assistant Dean for Admissions Bruce DelMonico described mission-driven Yale SOM as “the best business school to come to if you want to make a difference in society.” Yale SOM’s mission is to educate leaders for business and society. Reading this, some people assume Yale SOM wants to see applicants with lots of volunteer work, a background in non-profit leadership, or a desire to get into green energy. It’s true: Yale SOM is a leading destination for folks interested in social ventures, and the school has a unique tuition forgiveness program for alumni who go into non-profit leadership, but the fact remains that nearly 75% of SOM graduates go into consulting, financial services, or technology.

It’s great if you come from a one of these dominant industries or are eyeing one for your future, Yale SOM only asks that you think about how your work relates to the public interest. The school is looking for students who are unafraid to confront the ethical dimensions of their work and reflect on issues of citizenship and the common good. To change the world requires thinking and doing at scale, and Yale wants to give its graduates the tools to do so with the aid of a strong moral compass.

# 3

## SHARE YOUR DIVERSE PERSPECTIVE(S)

Dean Ted Snyder, who led Yale SOM from 2011-2019 set out to make SOM “the most global US business school.” International representation within the Yale SOM student body grew quickly and remains among the highest of the US business schools. The school has also made a sustained investment in diversity, equity, and inclusion, and was ahead of the curve in developing internal programs and forging partnerships with organizations like the Forté Foundation and The Consortium for Graduate Study in Management. The current Dean, Kerwin Charles, is a public policy expert whose scholarship focuses on wealth and income inequality, particularly as it relates to race and gender. In the 2020-21 cycle, Yale SOM asked all of its interviewees to reflect on a quote by Dean Charles about how diverse perspectives are essential to challenging established wisdom and advancing a university’s mission. As you put together your application, consider the many forces that have shaped your view of the world and your place therein. Weave them into your essays, hint at them on your resume, and/or prime your recommenders to feature your empathy and independence.

## BE YOURSELF

# 4

Yale SOM has a unique component to its admissions process: the behavioral assessment. Tested for years before it became required in 2019, the assessment is built around a set of inter- and intrapersonal competencies associated with success in business school. The 25-minute online test requires candidates to review 120 pairs of statements and select the one from each pair that best matches their own behaviors. This adaptive tool means that no two applicants receive the same set of statements.

The good news for applicants is that there is no need (or way) to prepare for the assessment. Relax, there truly are no right or wrong answers. The neutral framework of the assessment helps keep the admissions team – and the candidates – honest. Yale SOM has embraced the idea that great leaders come from many molds, and the admissions team is empowered to build a class of students with diverse personal and professional traits. For candidates, remember that the results will be reviewed in the context of your full application. If your recommenders describe you as detail-oriented systems thinker and you try to project yourself as a blue-sky visionary, it could raise some questions.

Just be yourself!

# 5

## EMBRACE THE VIDEO QUESTIONS

After submitting your Yale SOM application, you'll have to record real-time video answers to three standard interview questions. Designed to help assess communication skills and professional presence, these video questions also help the admissions committee see how well you think on your feet – an important skill in the MBA classroom and life.

Candidates have 60 to 90 seconds to answer basic behavioral questions. The tight timeframe can be a challenge, so practice answering specific questions in advance, and familiarize yourself with the online platform. For the actual recording, make sure to use a quiet space free of noise and distractions, dress professionally, adjust your sound and lighting, and speak clearly and concisely. More good news for applicants: Your recorded answers will be available for the whole admissions team to review, so you are not at the mercy of one interviewer's impression. Also, the recording can act as a little check to keep Yale SOM's interviewers at the top of their game, allowing the committee to cross reference your video with their report.

# ESSAYS

Yale wants to see an objective record of what you've done, and if it's presented clearly, they should be able to infer what moves you and what matters most in your life.



For in-depth essay analysis visit the Fortuna [Blog](#).



# DEADLINES & DATES

|              | APPLICATION<br>DEADLINE | FINAL DECISION  |
|--------------|-------------------------|-----------------|
| Early Action | 15 September 2020       | 8 December 2020 |
| Round 2      | 7 January 2021          | 26 March 2021   |
| Round 3      | 13 April 2021           | 18 May 2021     |



**The best time to  
apply is when you're  
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,  
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

# LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://FortunaAdmissions.com)

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://FortunaAdmissions.com)

